

GENESIS

EPISODE 101
"GENESIS, TONIGHT!"

Written by
Tyler Wade

1st White Revisions

Sunday, March 24th, 2024

CAST LIST

CAIN SHEPHERD
ABEL SHEPHERD
JERICO PRESLEY
SAMANTHA
GABRIEL
CAMERAMAN/THOMAS SPERNELL

KEVIN
REPORTER 1
REPORTER 2

LOCATION LIST**Interior Locations**

CAR

EDEN - BATHROOM

EDEN - BEDROOM

EDEN - KITCHEN

EDEN - THE FOYER

EDEN - THE SET

EDEN - THE WING

SHEPHERD HOUSE - BATHROOM

SHEPHERD HOUSE - BEDROOM

SHEPHERD HOUSE - LIVING ROOM

Exterior Locations

GARDEN STREET

BLACK SCREEN - **EPISODE 1**

SAMANTHA (V.O.)
We're live in three, two...

Static breathes to life as we look for a working channel.

There's a flurry of sound as we tune through them:

- Trump talks about shooting someone on 5th Avenue.
- Various clips of autocratic DeSantis rallies turned violent.
- Putin speaks Russian celebrating the completion of the invasion of Ukraine.
- A drought across the country has led to fires that have wiped out a majority of wheat crops in the U.S.
- A new virus spreads in Egypt.
- The global death toll rises to 3 million.

INT. EDEN - THE SET - DAWN

A broken and very likely stolen ON AIR sign turns on.

JERICHO lays in SAMANTHA'S lap on the floor. They're naked together. They bask in the sun's rays.

A CAMERAMAN stands at CAMERA 1 and messes with its settings. He has it pointed at a 1950s couch. He's far too handsome to be behind a camera, to have his face covered up by a hunk of metal, but alas he's here.

Samantha stares blankly at one of several monitors. This one has been tuned to a news channel. She listens to the chaos.

Jericho lies with his eyes closed. He quietly repeats a verse of scripture to himself.

JERICHO
And I saw when the Lamb opened one
of the seals, and I heard, as it
were the noise of thunder, one of
the four beasts saying, Come and
see.

SAMANTHA
(whispers)
You're talking in your sleep again.

JERICHO
(slowly opens his eyes and
smiles)
No, I wasn't. I'm awake.

Samantha looks at the camera. It's been on for a few hours now. Jericho hasn't worked up the guts to get in front of it yet.

SAMANTHA
How many people do we have right now?

CAMERAMAN
(checks a monitor)
5. Nope 3.

SAMANTHA
Are you sure you still want to do this?

JERICHO
Yeah, Of course. Of course, I do...
I've always wanted to host. When I was a kid I used to do it for our family dinners.

SAMANTHA
Really?

JERICHO
Yeah, I did. Right there in that kitchen. I'd print out menus, set the tables, put on my dad's suit coat, pour everyone a glass of wine.

Samantha strokes Jericho's hair.

SAMANTHA
And are you going to wear his coat today?

Jericho looks off to the master bedroom, his parent's old room.

JERICHO
Yeah, I think I will.

SAMANTHA
What about one of his ties?

JERICHO

I'll let you pick one out for me. A new one every day. It'll be our totem.

SAMANTHA

What type of tie are you going for today?

JERICHO

... Something that tells them I'm confident.

SAMANTHA

In what?

JERICHO

The beginning, even when facing the end.

SAMANTHA

Good.

(beat)

Have you thought about what you're going to call it yet?

JERICHO

I was hoping you had come up with something.

GABRIEL enters with a tie, three coffee cups, a cigarette in his mouth, and a fresh pot of coffee. He's handsome, if it weren't for all his vices eating away at his soul.

SAMANTHA

And as if on cue, here comes our footman.

Gabriel bends at the waist.

GABRIEL

Gabriel, at your service.

JERICHO

Thank you, my good sir.

GABRIEL

And what doth the news bringeth today. Debauchery or despair?

SAMANTHA

Both if you can believe it.

JERICHO

And don't forget Dictators.
DeSantis and
(in a French accent)
Marine Le Pen have absolutely lost
their minds.

SAMANTHA

They're out of touch with reality.

JERICHO

Exactly!

GABRIEL

It's a shame we've got a bunch of
narcissists leading us to the end
of the world, then again that
tracks.

(beat)

So what the hell are we calling
this?

SAMANTHA

We don't have a name yet. We were
just coming up with one.

JERICHO

Something about the beginning.

GABRIEL

Genesis.

SAMANTHA

Genesis?

GABRIEL

Like the bible. They'll eat that
shit up.

JERICHO

(echoes)

Genesis. I like it. What about you
Sammy?

SAMANTHA

I'll take it.

Gabriel pours them coffee.

GABRIEL

Genesis it is. Are you still
planning on running nonstop?

SAMANTHA

Yes.

JERICH0

(grabs Samantha's hand)

We are. We don't want to hide anything.

SAMANTHA

(enticing)

We want to talk about everything.

JERICH0

All the time.

GABRIEL

And what's your first segment?

JERICH0

Good question. Sam?

SAMANTHA

Sam? Oh, hell no. I'm not... oh you mean what did I come up with?

JERICH0

Yes, dear.

SAMANTHA

Well, I figured we could get some real, raw interviews. Interview someone that's been places. I wanna talk about *America*.

GABRIEL

America? No. With everything going on in Europe—

SAMANTHA

Exactly. With everything going on. You could call up your friend, the one in Texas. He can tell us about the humanitarian crisis.

JERICH0

I don't know. That doesn't seem like a great idea. I haven't talked to him in ages.

GABRIEL

Samantha, Texas is a large place. I doubt he knows anything—

JERICHO
He's in Austin Gabe.

GABRIEL
Oh, well in that case—

SAMANTHA
In that case, it's settled.

GABRIEL
Great, Samantha, you're in charge
of finding him a way out.

SAMANTHA
Oh please, everyone there needs a
way out. That's not our job though.
We'll just throw his face up on a
screen.

GABRIEL
But if we're going to interview
him, especially about that, we
should get him on the set.

SAMANTHA
No one said he had to be here in
person.

GABRIEL
Well, I'm funding this—

SAMANTHA
And we have loved you for that.

JERICHO
We really have.

GABRIEL
I'd like for him to be here in
person. Jericho?

JERICHO
I don't know.
(to Samantha)
Do you think he would really want
to talk about what's going on down
there? Do you think he even knows?

SAMANTHA
I think everyone wants to talk
about what's happening down there,
even if they don't have a clue
about what's going on.

GABRIEL

Well, I'm sure they do, but I don't think he's going to want to talk to us without an offer for a way out.

Samantha stands and takes a blanket with her to cover her breasts. She takes a cup of coffee from Gabriel and then walks to the master bedroom. She turns at the last moment.

SAMANTHA

Then I suppose we'll have to *provoke him*.

Samantha disappears.

JERICHO

Is she proposing she—

Gabriel sips his coffee.

GABRIEL

Yes. Yes, I think she is.

JERICHO

And you're ok with that?

GABRIEL

Are you?

JERICHO

Not particularly. We're not going to air that part, about her... are we?

A moment.

GABRIEL

... There's a lot of news out there.

JERICHO

Gabriel.

GABRIEL

And a lot of noise.

JERICHO

Answer me.

GABRIEL

I think there's a saying I heard one time, "Whatever gets them off will tune them in."

JERICHO
You can't be serious.

GABRIEL
I might just be.

CUT TO BLACK.

INT. SHEPHERD HOUSE - BEDROOM - MORNING

The back of a boy's head, CAIN. He's been given a fresh fade. He produces a pair of headphones.

WE SLIDE WITH THE MUFFS AS HE SLIPS EACH ONE ON, like in an Apple product commercial.

AS HE SLIDES THEM ON, we hear his music on each respective side (something like Creed or Linkin Park).

Cain bends over and lifts up an extremely heavy barbell. He huffs, puffs, and strains while counting each rep.

INT. SHEPHERD HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - CONTINUOUS

WE SLOW ZOOM out from a black TV screen. It flashes on and presents a TEST CARD. Images of the news fade in and out with static waves.

As we zoom, a still living room is revealed. A window is open. Outside, it's the end of spring. Birds chirp. Everything is fine.

Another boy, CAIN'S brother, ABEL ENTERS. He's home from college early after hearing the news.

He immediately puts his hand over his mouth and nose when he enters. Rotten, decaying, dead. The smell is horrid.

ABEL
Fuck me.

It smells like someone died in here. Like they've been dead.

ABEL (CONT'D)
I'm gone for three months.
(yelling)
DAD. CAIN.

Cain grunts and drops weight. He can't hear him.

WE WALK WITH ABEL INTO: